I need to understand which products, customers, and territories are driving — or missing — revenue targets this quarter, without spending half my week in spreadsheets.

Sarah Chen

Regional Sales Manager
Enterprise Sales Intelligence Platform · Primary User

Situation and context

What is the typical context of the real people represented by this archetype?

- Promoted from top-performing sales rep, now responsible for a team of 6–12 account executives across a territory or region
- Spends 60–70% of her week in meetings: pipeline reviews, deal coaching, stakeholder updates, customer calls
- Lives inside Salesforce all day but gets financial data from a completely separate ERP system — the two never sync cleanly
- Reports upward to a VP of Sales who wants a clean story every Monday; reports downward to reps who want to know where they stand vs their individual quota
- Career measured by one number — quota attainment — usually expressed as % to target monthly and quarterly

Goals and motivations

Beyond our product and service, what motivates this person?

- Wants to be promoted to VP of Sales — every quarter that she hits target is a step closer
- Deeply competitive by nature; motivated by leaderboards, rankings, and knowing exactly where her team sits vs other regions
- Cares about her team's success personally — a rep who misses quota reflects on her, but she also genuinely wants them to grow
- Recognition from senior leadership matters enormously — being the manager who "runs a tight, data-driven team" is a reputation she actively builds
- Financially motivated — her own compensation includes a bonus tied directly to regional revenue performance

Fears and frustrations

What keeps them up at night? What does a bad day look like?

- A quarter-end that looks fine on Monday and falls apart by Friday because the pipeline data was stale or wrong
- Not knowing which deals are actually healthy vs which reps are sandbagging or inflating their forecast
- A key customer going quiet and no early warning signal — finding out they churned only when the renewal doesn't close
- Numbers she presents to the VP being challenged because ERP and CRM show different figures — public embarrassment in front of leadership
- Missing her quarterly target by a small margin because she didn't catch a territory underperforming early enough to course-correct

Tasks and tactics

What does the person do to accomplish their goals?

- Runs a weekly pipeline review with every rep — interrogates deal stage, next action, close date, and deal size manually because she doesn't trust the CRM data blindly
- Exports CRM and ERP data into Excel every Monday morning, spends 3–4 hours reconciling the two into a single view she trusts
- Calls her top 3 accounts personally every month regardless of whether there is an active deal — relationship maintenance
- Uses gut instinct and experience to flag deals that look risky, because there is no automated churn or risk signal available to her right now
- Prepares a Monday morning summary slide for the VP by hand — copy-pasting numbers from multiple sources into a PowerPoint
- Coaches underperforming reps one-on-one using anecdote and experience rather than data, because she cannot easily pull rep-level performance breakdowns quickly
- Tracks her own shadow spreadsheet of territory performance that she trusts more than any official system report

I don't mind doing the analysis. What I can't afford is spending 80% of my time just trying to trust the data before I even start.

Marcus Obi

Finance Business Analyst
bridge between raw financial data and the CFO's decision-making — if his reports are wrong, the whole business makes decisions on bad information..

Situation and context

What is the typical context of the real people represented by this archetype?

- 3–7 years into a finance or business analysis career, likely holds a degree in accounting, finance, or business analytics
- Sits in the Finance or FP&A (Financial Planning & Analysis) team, reports to the CFO or Finance Director
- Owns the monthly management pack — the single most scrutinised document in the organisation
- Works across both ERP (for actuals — revenue, COGS, refunds) and CRM (for pipeline and customer acquisition data) but neither system was designed to talk to each other
- Measured on accuracy and speed — a late pack or a wrong number is a career-defining mistake

Goals and motivations

Beyond our product and service, what motivates this person?

- Wants to move into a senior FP&A or Finance Manager role — being known as the analyst who "modernised reporting" is a powerful career story
- Takes deep professional pride in the accuracy of his numbers — a wrong figure in the CFO pack feels like a personal failure
- Wants to spend his time on actual analysis and insight, not on data wrangling — he became an analyst to find patterns, not to run VLOOKUPs
- Motivated by having a defensible, auditable answer to every question — "where did this number come from?" should always have a clean answer
- Respected by the CFO when he brings insight, not just numbers — proactively spotting a margin trend before it becomes a problem earns him credibility

Fears and frustrations

What keeps them up at night? What does a bad day look like?

- Presenting a revenue figure to the CFO that gets challenged because ERP and CRM show different totals — and not being able to explain the gap on the spot
- A refund or return that wasn't captured correctly inflating net revenue in the monthly pack — discovered only after the board has seen it
- Month-end close approaching and the source data still isn't reconciled — the pack is due Friday and it's already Wednesday
- An ad-hoc request from the CFO at 4pm for a margin breakdown by product category that should take 10 minutes but will actually take 3 hours because the data is scattered
- Being asked "can you rerun this but for last year?" and realising historical data was overwritten in the spreadsheet six months ago

Tasks and tactics

What does the person do to accomplish their goals?

- Runs a manual month-end process: export from ERP, export from CRM, paste into master workbook, run reconciliation tab, fix mismatches by hand, then build the pack from the outputs
- Maintains a master Excel workbook that he has built and refined over 18 months — it is the single source of truth for finance reporting but only he fully understands how it works
- Creates a separate "audit trail" tab in Excel where he logs every manual adjustment he makes and why — his personal governance layer because there is no system-level auditability
- Cross-checks every major figure against at least two sources before including it in the CFO pack
- Responds to ad-hoc CFO requests by rebuilding a slice of the master model from scratch each time — there is no self-service query layer

I don't need more data. I need fewer surprises — and I need to know that when someone shows me a number, it means the same thing it meant last month

Priya

she reads the output and makes million-dollar decisions based on it. Her trust in the numbers is the ultimate measure of success.

Situation and context

What is the typical context of the real people represented by this archetype?

- 15–25 years of finance experience, likely a CPA or MBA, has seen multiple data and reporting tool implementations across her career
- Sits at the executive table alongside the CEO and VP of Sales — her view of the business is strategic and forward-looking, not operational
- Consumes the monthly management pack that Marcus produces, but also asks ad-hoc questions in board meetings that currently take days to answer
- Deeply sceptical of data initiatives — has seen too many "data transformation" projects that delivered dashboards nobody used
- Does not use Excel or any BI tool directly — she reads formatted reports and asks questions of the people who built them

Goals and motivations

Beyond our product and service, what motivates this person?

- Wants the company to make faster, better capital allocation decisions — which product lines to invest in, which territories to expand, which customers to prioritise
- Building credibility with the board and investors requires consistent, defensible numbers — inconsistency in reporting is a governance risk she takes personally
- Interested in reducing the dependency on one or two people who "know where the data lives" — key-person risk in finance reporting keeps her up at night
- Wants to move toward quarterly forecasting being data-driven rather than intuition-driven — that requires a trustworthy historical baseline that currently doesn't exist
- Proud of building a finance function that scales — a data warehouse that self-serves Sarah and Marcus without manual intervention is the kind of infrastructure investment she champions

Fears and frustrations

What keeps them up at night? What does a bad day look like?

- A board meeting where two people cite different revenue figures from different systems and no one can explain which one is right — in front of investors
- The business making a pricing or expansion decision based on margin data that turned out to be wrong because refunds were excluded from the calculation
- The month-end close taking longer than it should because the data reconciliation is entirely manual and dependent on Marcus being available
- A regulatory or audit question that requires pulling historical financial data quickly — and finding out it was never stored consistently
- The company scaling its sales team into new territories and the reporting infrastructure not being able to keep up

Tasks and tactics

What does the person do to accomplish their goals?

- Reviews the monthly CFO pack prepared by Marcus and asks probing questions — her job is to challenge the numbers, not accept them
- Sends ad-hoc data requests to the finance team when board questions arise — "can you get me margin by product line for the last 8 quarters by end of week?"
- Relies entirely on Marcus's audit trail and judgment for data accuracy — she has no independent way to verify figures
- Advocates internally for data infrastructure investment when she can frame it in terms of risk reduction and decision quality — not in terms of technology
- Sets the KPI definitions that the whole business uses — what "revenue" means, whether refunds are netted out, how customer acquisition cost is calculated — but these definitions currently live only in her head and Marcus's spreadsheet